

Step 6

Seek - Seek God through prayer and meditation on His Word and His Works.

- *The Lord is a refuge for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble. Those who know your name trust in you, for you, Lord, have never forsaken those who **seek** you. Psalms 9:9-10 NIV*

What it means to “seek” God - (to search out (by any method; specifically in worship or prayer); by implication to strive after: - {ask} {beg} {beseech} {desire} {enquire} {get} make {inquisition} {procure} (make) {request} {require})

Reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and his will for my life and to gain the power to follow His will.

We salt through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God, praying only for knowledge of his will for us and power to carry that out.

Let the message of Christ dwell among you richly. Colossians 3:16

Think about it

The best ways to prevent relapse can be surmised in the acrostic **RELAPSE**

Reserve a daily quiet time

Reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and His will for my life and gain the power to follow His will.

Watch and pray so that you will not fall into temptation. The spirit is willing but the flesh is weak. Mark 14:38

Evaluate

Your evaluation needs to include your physical, emotional, relational, and spiritual health. And don't forget the value of doing a heart check.

Are you -

Hurting

Exhausted

Angry

Resentful

Tense

Special instructions for this step are found in Romans 12:3-17 *be honest in your estimate of yourself... Hate what is wrong... stand on the side of the good... Love each other... Be patient in trouble... Do things in such a way that everyone can see you are honest and clear through.*

Listen to Jesus

We need to take a timeout from the world's rat race long enough to listen to our bodies, our minds, and our souls. We need to slow down enough to hear the Lord's directions
Test everything that is said to be sure it is true, and if it is, then accept it. 1Thessalonians 5:21

Let everyone be sure that he is doing his very best, for then he will have the personal satisfaction of work well done and won't need to compare himself with someone else. Galatians 6:4

Listen to the Lord. Hear what he is telling you. Isaiah 1:10

Alone and quiet time

Jesus Christ spent time alone with his father. You need to do the same. Set a daily appointment time to be alone with God. Listen carefully, learn how to hear God!
Be still, and know that I am God. Psalm 46:10

Plug into God's power through prayer

God's guidance and direction can start when your demand stop! Be specific in your prayer requests. Pray about everything, asking for God's perfect will.

Don't worry about anything, instead, pray about everything, tell God your needs and don't forget to thank him for his answers. Philippians 4:6

Slow down long enough to hear God's answer

We can become impatient. We want our prayers answered now! We need to remember that our timing can be flawed, while God's timing is perfect!

Listen to me. Keep silence and I will teach you wisdom! Job 33:33

If you do this, you will experience God's peace, which is far more wonderful than the human mind can understand. His peace. Will keep your thoughts and your heart quiet and at rest as you trust. In Christ Jesus, Philippians 4:7

Enjoy your growth

Rejoice and celebrate the small successes along your road to recovery! Always remember you are on a journey, a journey of several steps. Maintaining an attitude of gratitude is like taking spiritual vitamins.

Share your victories, no matter how small, with others in your group. Your growth will give others hope!

Be joyful. Always, pray at all times, be thankful in all circumstances. This is what God wants from you in your life and union with Christ Jesus 1 Thessalonians 5:16

Here are a few final suggestions for preventing relapse

1. Pray and read your Bible daily. Establish a specific time of day to have your quiet time
2. Make attending your overcomer meeting a priority. Stay close to your support team.
3. Spend time with your family (if they are safe). If they are not, spend time with your church family.
4. Get involved in service. Volunteer!

Write about it

What are some of the ways(tools) that you have developed in your recovery to prevent relapse?

Do a **H-E-A-R-T** check right now. Are you...

Hurting?

Exhausted?

Angry?

Resentful?

Tense?

Specifically, what do you do when you are, hurting, exhausted, angry, resentful, tense

Write your listening skills from one to 10, 10 being the best.._____

What are some ways that you think you could improve your listening skills with others?

What are some ways that you could improve your listening skills with God?

Describe what a quiet time means to you and why it is important.

How could you improve your prayer time? Be specific.

When do you pray? _____

Where do you pray? _____

After you pray, do you slow down long enough to hear God's answer? _____ What does the word meditation in this step mean to you?

What are some of the other things that you do in your recovery to help you on your journey and prevent relapse?

I think we all agree that recovery is joy, but it also requires hard work. What do you do to celebrate your recovery, even the small victories?

You will seek me and find me when you seek me with all your heart.

Jeremiah 29:13 NIV

If my people, who are called by my name, will humble themselves and pray and seek my face and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, and I will forgive their sin and will heal their land.

2 Chronicles 7:14 NIV

But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.

Matthew 6:33 NIV

“So I say to you: Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives; the one who seeks finds; and to the one who knocks, the door will be opened.

Luke 11:9-10 NIV

The Lord is a refuge for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble. Those who know your name trust in you, for you, Lord, have never forsaken those who seek you.

Psalms 9:9-10 NIV

My heart says of you, “Seek his face!” Your face, Lord, I will seek.

Psalms 27:8 NIV

Show me your ways, Lord, teach me your paths. Guide me in your truth and teach me, for you are God my Savior, and my hope is in you all day long.

Psalms 25:4-5 NIV

Indeed, if you call out for insight and cry aloud for understanding, and if you look for it as for silver and search for it as for hidden treasure, then you will understand the fear of the Lord and find the knowledge of God. For the Lord gives wisdom; from his mouth come knowledge and understanding.

Proverbs 2:3-6 NIV